

Question 25 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

Explain the role of feedback and counselling in an HRD system.

Introduction

Forms, ratings and training certificates do not by themselves change a human being. Conversation does. Feedback is information given to a person about his or her behaviour or results, so that the person can continue what is effective and change what is not. Counselling, in the notes, is discussion of an emotional problem with the general objective of decreasing it; it is also described as purposeful conversation in an understanding atmosphere so that the individual can make his or her own decision from among available choices.

In an HRD system, feedback and counselling are the human processes that make appraisal, training and career planning actually work. Without them, HRD is paperwork.

Detailed points

- 1. Role of feedback — information for improvement.** Good feedback is specific, timely, and about behaviour or work, not about the person's character. 'In yesterday's client meeting you interrupted twice, so we missed their concern' can be used. 'You are poor' cannot. Feedback reduces the gap between how the employee sees himself and how the work really looks. That gap-reduction is learning.
- 2. Feedback must be two-way.** The employee also feeds back on unclear orders, missing tools, and unrealistic targets. This improves the organisation, not only the individual, and matches the HRD climate value of openness. One-way scolding is not HRD feedback.
- 3. Role of counselling — a helping relationship.** Counselling deals with an emotional problem through communication, generally to understand and reduce the disorder. Conditions may be on or off the job: job dissatisfaction, resistance to change, alienation, frustration, conflict, stress, aggression, apathy, withdrawal. The counsellor — often the manager, sometimes a specialist — helps the person think more clearly and choose. Basic purpose: assist the individual to decide, not to issue orders in a soft voice.
- 4. Functions and aims of counselling (from notes).** Functions: advise, reassure, communicate, release of emotional tension, clarified thinking, reorientation. Aims listed by Eisenberg and Delaney include understanding self, making decisions, setting achievable growth goals, planning present for desired future, solving personal and interpersonal problems, coping, controlling self-defeating emotions, better transaction skills, and positive self-regard. These aims are clearly developmental.
- 5. Link to appraisal, training and career.** Without a counselling discussion, appraisal is a signature on a form. After training, feedback tells whether behaviour changed. Career counselling prevents wild hopes and maps next steps. Thus feedback and counselling connect every other subsystem to the living person.
- 6. Who should counsel, and cautions.** Supervisors/managers, specialists, and professional counsellors. Managers need training in listening. Some cases (serious mental health, family crisis) need referral. Confidentiality is essential; leaked counselling destroys HRD climate. The counsellor's approach depends on the situation and the personality of the counselee.
- 7. A simple counselling process (notes).** Step 1: describe the changed behaviour; show concern with work performance. Step 2: get employee comments; keep negative comments on performance, not on character. Step 3: agree on a solution; emphasise confidentiality. Step 4: summarise and get commitment. Step 5: follow up. This process is the role made practical.
- 8. Climate role.** Skilled, respectful feedback and counselling build trust and openness. Harsh, public, or absent feedback destroys climate. So their role is both individual development and system health. HRD must train managers in these skills; otherwise the whole system is a machine without a heart.

Conclusion. *Feedback informs the employee about work in a usable way; counselling helps the person handle emotions, choices and problems so that change can happen. Together they turn HRD data into human development. Write definitions, roles, links, process and confidentiality in the exam.*